

Assignment:- 4

Name: Kaushal Kumar Raj

PRN: 240205241023

Branch: B.Tech CSE with AI & ML

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Subject: Operating System.

① What is virtual memory? why is it needed?
Explain its benefits.

→ Virtual memory is a technique where secondary storage (disk) is used to extend RAM, giving the illusion of a larger memory.

Need:

- Programs exceed physical memory
- Efficient memory use
- Supports multitasking.

Benefits:

- Run large programs
- Better memory utilization
- Process isolation
- More processes can run simultaneously.

② Explain the concepts of Demand paging. Describe the steps involved in handling a page fault.

→ Demand Paging : Pages are loaded only when required.

Page Fault Handling:

- 1) Page not found in memory
- 2) Trap to OS
- 3) Check validity
- 4) Locate page on disk
- 5) Find free frame / replace page
- 6) Load page
- 7) Update page table
- 8) Restart instruction.

③ What is a Page Replacement Algorithm? Name any three algorithms.

→ It decides which page to remove when memory is full.

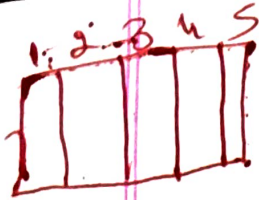
Examples:

- FIFO
- LRU
- optimal

④ Given reference string : 7, 0, 1, 2, 0, 3, 0, 4, 2, 3, 0, 3, 2.
Calculate page faults for FIFO with 4 frames.

⇒ step	page	frame after operation	Fault / Hit
1	7	7 ---	Fault (1)
2	0	70 --	Fault (2)
3	1	701 -	Fault (3)
4	2	7012	Fault (4)
5	0	7012	Hit
6	3	3012 (7 Replaced)	Fault (5)
7	0	3012	Hit
8	4	3412 (0 Replaced)	Fault (6)
9	2	3412	Hit
10	3	3412	Hit
11	0	3402 (1 Replaced)	Fault (7)
12	3	3402	Hit
13	2	3402	Hit

∴ Total faults Page = 7



⑤ for the same reference string (7, 0, 1, 2, 0, 3, 0, 4, 2, 3, 0, 3, 2). calculate page fault for optimal with 4 frames.

Step	Page	Frames after operation	Fault/Hit
1	7	7 - - -	Fault (1)
2	0	7 0 - -	Fault (2)
3	1	7 0 1 -	Fault (3)
4	2	7 0 1 2	Fault (4)
5	0	7 0 1 2	Hit
6	3	3 0 1 2 (7 replaced)	Fault (5)
7	0	3 0 1 2	Hit
8	4	3 0 4 2 (1 replaced)	Fault (6)
9	2	3 0 4 2	Hit
10	3	3 0 4 2	Hit
11	0	3 0 4 2	Hit
12	3	3 0 4 2	Hit
13	2	3 0 4 2	Hit

∴ Total page faults = 6

⑥ What is Belady's Anomaly? Illustrate with an example of the FIFO algorithm.

→ Belady's Anomaly: Increasing frames can increase page faults.

Example:

Reference → 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 5, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

- 3 frames → 9 faults
- 4 frames → 10 faults

⑦ Explain the Least Recently used (LRU) page replacement algorithm. How is it implemented?

→ LRU: Replace the page that was least recently used.

Implementation:

- counters (timestamps)
- stack method

⑧ What is Thrashing? What are its causes and how can the system detect it?

→ Thrashing: System spends more time swapping pages than executing.

Causes:

- Too many processes
- Insufficient frames

Detection:

- High page fault rate
- Low CPU utilization

⑨ Explain the working set model for thrashing prevention.

→ Working set = pages used recently.

Idea:

- Allocate enough frames to hold working set.
- Prevents excessive page faults.

⑩ Define a file. List and explain the various file attributes.

→ File : collection of related data stored on disk.

Attributes:

- Name
- Size
- Type
- Location
- Permissions
- Creation / modified time

⑪ Describe the various file operations that an operating system provides.

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- Create
 - Open
 - Read
 - Write
 - Close
 - Delete
 - Seek

⑫ Differentiate between sequential Access and Direct Access methods.

→ Sequential

- Access in order
- Slow for large files
- Simple

Direct

- Random access
- Fast
- Complex

⑬ Explain the Tree-Structured Directory structure with a diagram. What are its advantages?

→ Structure: Hierarchical (like folders inside folders)

Advantages:

- Organized storage
- Easy searching
- Supports grouping

⑭ What is File system Mounting? why is it necessary?

→ Mounting: Attaching a file system to a directory.

Need:

- Access files from different devices.
- Integrate storage into one system

⑮ Explain any two file allocation methods with their advantages and disadvantages.

→ 1. contiguous Allocation

- fast access
- External fragmentation

2. Linked Allocation

- No fragmentation
- Slow random access

(16) a) consider the following page reference string:
1, 2, 3, 4, 2, 1, 5, 6, 2, 1, 2, 3, 7, 6, 3,
2, 1, 2, 3, 6. How many page faults would
occur for the following replacement algorithms
assuming 3 and then 4 frames? Remember
all frames are initially empty.

i) FIFO

ii) optimal

iii) LRU

⇒ Reference string:

1, 2, 3, 4, 2, 1, 5, 6, 2, 1, 2, 3, 7, 6, 3, 2, 1, 2, 3, 6

i) FIFO (first-in first out)

- 3 frames → 16 Page faults
- 4 frames → 14 page faults

ii) optimal

- 3 frames → 11 Page faults
- 4 frames → 8 page faults

iii) LRU (Least Recently used)

- 3 frames → 15 Page faults
- 4 frames → 10 Page faults

b) Based on your calculations, which algorithm performed best? why?

→ It replaces the page that will not be used for the longest time in the future.
• This gives the minimum possible page faults.

(Algorithm)	(3 frames)	(4 frames)
FIFO	16	14
LRU	15	10
optimal	11	8

17) a) Explain in detail the concept of "Thrashing". Discuss the causes and the working-set model as a solution.

→ Thrashing: system spends more time paging than executing.
Causes:

- Too many processes
- Less memory
- High page faults

Working-set model:

- keeps required pages in memory
- Allocates enough frames
- Reduces page faults

b) What is the "Page Fault Frequency" (PFF) approach to control thrashing?

→ PFF: controls thrashing using page fault rate.

- High fault rate → increases P_{pages}
- Low fault rate → decreases P_{pages}
- Maintains optimal performance

18.a) Discuss the various Directory structures (single-level, two-level, tree-structured, Acyclic-graph, General graph). Compare them in terms of file naming, sharing and complexity.

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- Single-level: Simple, no grouping, naming conflicts
 - Two-level: Separate user dirs, less conflict
 - Tree: Hierarchical, efficient search
 - Acyclic graph: Allows sharing, no cycles
 - General graph: Full sharing, cycles possible

Comparison:

- Naming: Tree > Two-level > single
- Sharing: Graph > Acyclic > Tree
- Complexity: General graph (Highest)

b) What are the challenges in implementing a general graph directory structure? How are they resolved?

→ challenges:

- Cycles
- Infinite loops
- Deletion issues

Solutions:

- Garbage collection
- Reference counting

19.a) Describe in detail the three main free allocation methods: contiguous, linked, and indexed. Compare their performance for sequential and direct access.

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- Contiguous: Fast, but fragmentation
 - Linked: No fragmentation, slow random access
 - Indexed: Balanced, supports direct access

Performance

- Sequential - contiguous best
- Direct - indexed best

b) Explain how the UNIX inode implements indexed allocation using direct, single indirect, and double indirect blocks.

- • Direct blocks: store file data directly
- Single indirect: points to block of addresses
- Double indirect: points to blocks of pointers
- supports large files efficiently.

20. a) What is the difference between a page and a frame? Explain the process of address translation in a paging system with a TLB.

→ Page: Logical memory unit
Frame: Physical memory unit

Translation:

- CPU → logical address
- TLB checks mapping
- If miss → page table lookup
- Get frame number.

Q. V. U.

b) Given a 32-bit logical address space, a Page size of 4kB, and a Page table entry size of 4 bytes. Calculate the size of the page table. What problem does this create? How is it solved using multi-level paging?

→ Page size = 4kB → offset = 12 bit

• Page = 2^{20}

Page table size:

= $2^{20} \times 4 \text{ bytes}$

= 4 MB

Problem:

- Large memory usage

Solution:

- multi-level paging reduces size.

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